RECRUITMENT GUIDE OFF-CAMPUS & COMPETITIONS

Master Off-Campus Internship & Hackathon Calendar

A comprehensive timeline of seasonal hiring drives, algorithmic contests, research tracks, and university programs.

Q1 Quarter 1: July – September (Odd Semester Start)

Program / Category	Target Batch	Timeline	Selection Focus & Skills	Duration & Outcome
Accenture Tech Next Corporate Challenge	Engineering Students	July	Full-Stack prototypes, problem solving, communication skills.	**Hiring Challenge** (Internship / Entry roles)
Juspay Hiring Challenge Algorithmic Challenge	3rd & 4th Year	August	Advanced DSA, graph algorithms, multi-threading, OOPs.	**Internship + PPO** (₹40k–₹50k/mo stipend)
Smart India Hackathon National Hackathon (Govt)	All College Years	June – August	Prototype building, Full-Stack dev, domain problem solving.	**₹2+ Cr prize pool**, national direct recognition
MLH Fellowship Open-Source Fellowship	All Developers	August	Git/GitHub, open-source code contributions, system design.	**12 Weeks** (Paid / Stipend-backed remote)
Google STEP Internship Early-Year Drive	1st & 2nd Year	Sept – Oct	Core DSA (Arrays, Strings, Recursion, Trees), CS Basics.	**10–12 Weeks Summer** (PPO conversion path)
Google University Drive Off-Campus Drive	3rd & 4th Year	Aug – Oct	High-level DSA, LeetCode Medium/Hard, CS Fundamentals.	**10–12 Weeks** Summer Internship
Amazon Off-Campus Drive University Hiring	3rd & 4th Year	Aug – Oct	DSA (DP, Trees, Graphs), Leadership Principles, OOPs.	**2–6 Months** (High conversion to FTE)

Q2 Quarter 2: October – December (Odd Semester End)

Program / Category	Target Batch	Timeline	Selection Focus & Skills	Duration & Outcome
Microsoft Imagine Cup Global Competition	All College Years	Oct – Nov	Novel software product, AI/Cloud integration, pitching.	**Global Prizes** + Recruiter Visibility
Meta Hacker Cup Algorithmic Contest	Open to All	Oct – Nov	Pure Competitive Programming (Hard Algorithms & Math).	**Interviews** for top ranked performers
Microsoft Research (MSR) Research Internship	Pre-final / PG / PhD	Nov – Jan	Deep learning, systems research, mathematical modeling.	**6 Months** (Winter to Summer track)

Q3 Quarter 3: January – March (Even Semester Start)

Program / Category	Target Batch	Timeline	Selection Focus & Skills	Duration & Outcome
Microsoft Explore Early College Program	1st & 2nd Year	**February**	Basic DSA, fundamental OOPs, dev projects.	**8 Weeks** (PPO next year opportunity)
Google Summer of Code Open-Source Program	18+ Devs / Students	**Jan (Org) / Feb**	Full-Stack dev, Git proficiency, proposal writing.	**12–22 Weeks** (Global stipend)
Google Student Researcher Industry Research	2nd, 3rd, 4th Year	**Jan – Feb**	ML/AI, advanced algorithms, research methodology.	**Flexible** research tenure
TCS Research Internship Corporate R&D	Pre-final & Final	**Jan – Feb**	CS fundamentals, algorithm design, architecture.	**6–8 Weeks** research internship
5G Innovation Hackathon Govt of India (DoT)	Engineering Bats	**March**	Telecom, networking, embedded, IoT/Cloud solutions.	**Project grants**, incubation, hiring

Q4 Quarter 4: April – June (Even Semester End / Summer Onset)

Program / Category	Target Batch	Timeline	Selection Focus & Skills	Duration & Outcome
JPMC (Code For Good) Corporate Hackathon	2nd & 3rd Year	**April**	DSA round + 24-hr team build for non-profits.	**6 Mos / Summer** (High PPO rate)
Amazon HackOn Corporate Hackathon	3rd & 4th Year	**April – May**	DSA coding assessment + product dev sprints.	**Summer / 6-Mo** + FTE conversion
Goldman Sachs Hackathon FinTech Hackathon	Select / Off-Campus	**April**	DSA, data analysis, quantitative logic, architecture.	**Summer Intern** (₹1L+/mo stipend)
Digital India Internship Government of India	UG/PG Tech	**April**	AI/ML, Cloud, Cyber Security, Blockchain systems.	**2–3 Months** (Govt Certificate)
DRDO Student Training National Defence Labs	2nd & 3rd Year	**May – June**	Embedded, C/C++, AI, electronics, systems.	**4–8 Weeks** (Research credential)
Cisco Ideathon Product Innovation	Pre-final & Final	**June**	Networking fundamentals, DSA, practical solutions.	**6 Months** (Dream FTE pathway)
Flipkart GRiD Hackathon National Tech Contest	All Eng. Batches	**June – July**	E-commerce scale, robotics/AI, full-stack systems.	**6-Month Intern** + PPO offer

ROLLING Year-Round Programs (Continuous & Rolling Portals)

Program / Agency	Eligibility	Portal Window	Selection Criteria & Program Stipend
Infosys InStep Flagship Corporate	Global UG / PG	**Rolling**	Resume screening, project depth, system fundamentals (Paid).
PM Internship Scheme Public-Private Drive	18–25 Years	**Batches**	Tied to Tata, Wipro, Tech Mahindra (₹9,000/mo, 6–9 months).
ISRO Student Training Space Agency R&D	UG Engineering	**Dept. Rolling**	Faculty recommendation, academic GPA, space-tech relevance.

STRATEGY Key Preparation Rules & Application Tactics